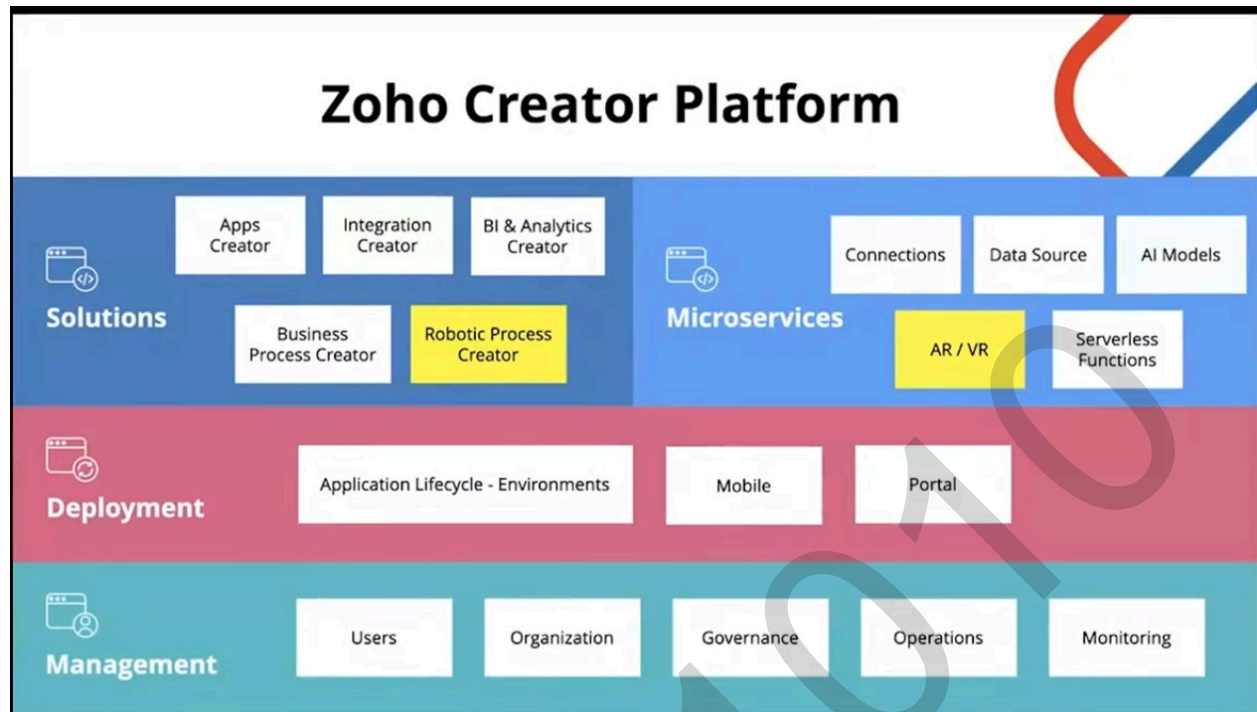


Exp 2: Zoho Creator Platform

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Zoho Creator Platform

It is a **low-code application development platform** that allows users to build, deploy, integrate, and manage business applications with minimal coding.

1. Solutions

These are the tools used to create different business solutions.

- **Apps Creator**

- Used to build web and mobile applications.
- Create forms, workflows, reports, and dashboards.
- Example: Employee Management System.

- **Integration Creator**

- Connects Zoho Creator with other applications.
- Integrates with Zoho apps, Google Workspace, payment gateways, etc.

- Helps exchange data between applications.

- **BI & Analytics Creator**

- Used for data visualization and business intelligence.
- Creates dashboards, charts, and reports.
- Helps in decision-making.

- **Business Process Creator**

- Automates business workflows.
- Defines approval processes and task routing.
- Example: Leave approval workflow.

- **Robotic Process Creator (RPA)**

- Automates repetitive manual tasks.
- Bots perform actions like data entry, copying information, and generating reports.
- Saves time and reduces human effort.

2. Microservices

Provides additional services that enhance applications.

- **Connections**

- Securely connects external services and APIs.
- Example: Connect to Gmail, Salesforce, PayPal.

- **Data Source**

- Accesses data from databases or cloud services.
- Allows applications to use external data.

- **AI Models**

- Adds Artificial Intelligence features.
- Examples:
 - Image recognition
 - Prediction
 - OCR

- Sentiment analysis
- Chatbots

- **AR/VR**

- Supports Augmented Reality and Virtual Reality applications.
- Useful for training, product visualization, and simulations.

- **Serverless Functions**

- Runs custom code without managing servers.
- Executes automatically when triggered by events.
- Example: Send email after form submission.

3. Deployment

Used to publish and make applications available to users.

- **Application Lifecycle – Environments**

- Manages development stages.
- Separate environments for:
 - Development
 - Testing
 - Production
- Ensures safe updates before release.

- **Mobile**

- Deploys applications as mobile apps.
- Accessible on Android and iOS devices.

- **Portal**

- Creates customer or employee portals.
- External users can log in securely and use the application.

4. Management

Helps administer and monitor applications.

- **Users**

- Manages user accounts.
- Assigns roles and permissions.

- **Organization**

- Controls organization settings.
- Manages departments, teams, and resources.

- **Governance**

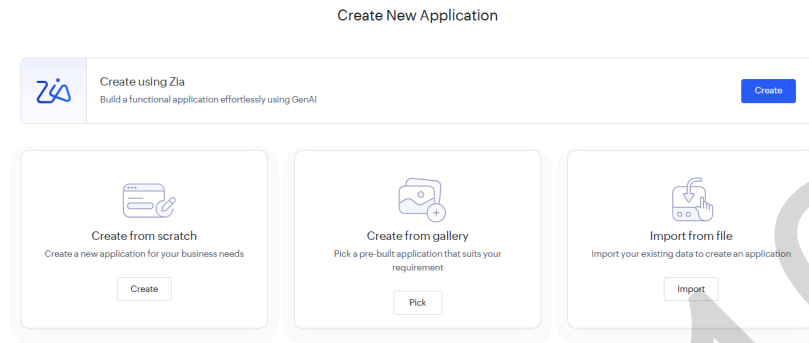
- Enforces security policies and compliance.
- Controls who can access what.

- **Operations**

- Handles application maintenance.
- Manages backups, updates, and performance.

- **Monitoring**

- Tracks application health and usage.
- Detects errors and monitors performance.



Create New Application

The **Create New Application** page allows users to start building a business application using different methods based on their requirements and experience level.

1. Create using Zia (GenAI)

- Uses **Zia**, Zoho's AI assistant, to automatically generate an application.
- Users simply describe their requirements in natural language.
- Zia creates forms, workflows, reports, and application logic.
- Suitable for beginners and rapid application development.
- **Example:** "Create a student attendance management system."

Advantages:

- Fast application creation
- Minimal coding required
- AI-generated forms and workflows

2. Create from Scratch

- Builds a completely new application from the beginning.
- Users design forms, workflows, reports, dashboards, and automation manually.
- Provides maximum flexibility and customization.
- Best for applications with unique business requirements.

Advantages:

- Full control over application design
- Highly customizable
- Suitable for complex business applications

3. Create from Gallery

- Uses pre-built application templates provided by Zoho.
- Users select a template and customize it according to their needs.
- Saves development time.
- Suitable for common business applications.

Examples of Templates:

- Inventory Management
- CRM
- Employee Management
- Help Desk
- Project Management

Advantages:

- Quick deployment
- Ready-made features
- Less development effort

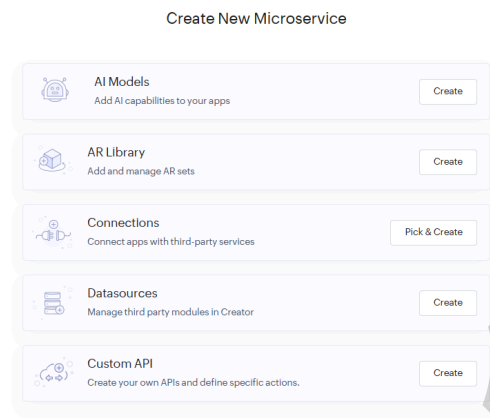
4. Import from File

- Creates an application by importing existing data files.
- Supports importing files such as Excel or CSV.
- Zoho automatically creates forms based on the imported data.
- Useful when migrating data from spreadsheets.

Advantages:

- Easy data migration
- Automatically generates forms
- Reduces manual data entry

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Create New Microservice

The **Create New Microservice** page enables users to add independent services such as AI, APIs, external integrations, AR features, and data sources to their Zoho Creator applications.

1. AI Models

- Adds Artificial Intelligence capabilities to applications.
- Can perform tasks such as prediction, image recognition, OCR, text analysis, and chatbots.
- Improves automation and decision-making.

Examples:

- Customer sentiment analysis
- Invoice OCR
- AI chatbot
- Image classification

Advantages:

- Smart automation
- Faster decision-making
- Improved user experience

2. AR Library

- Used to add and manage Augmented Reality (AR) assets.
- Helps create interactive AR experiences.
- Useful for training, education, product visualization, and maintenance.

Examples:

- Virtual product display
- Equipment maintenance guide
- Interactive learning applications

Advantages:

- Better user engagement
- Real-time visualization
- Enhanced learning experience

3. Connections

- Connects Zoho Creator applications with third-party services.
- Enables secure API integration without writing complex code.
- Supports cloud services and external applications.

Examples:

- Gmail
- Google Drive
- Salesforce
- PayPal
- Slack

Advantages:

- Easy integration
- Secure authentication
- Automated data exchange

4. Datasources

- Connects applications to external databases or data sources.
- Retrieves and updates data from third-party systems.
- Allows applications to work with centralized business data.

Examples:

- MySQL
- PostgreSQL
- SQL Server
- Oracle Database

Advantages:

- Centralized data management
- Real-time data access
- Reduced data duplication

5. Custom API

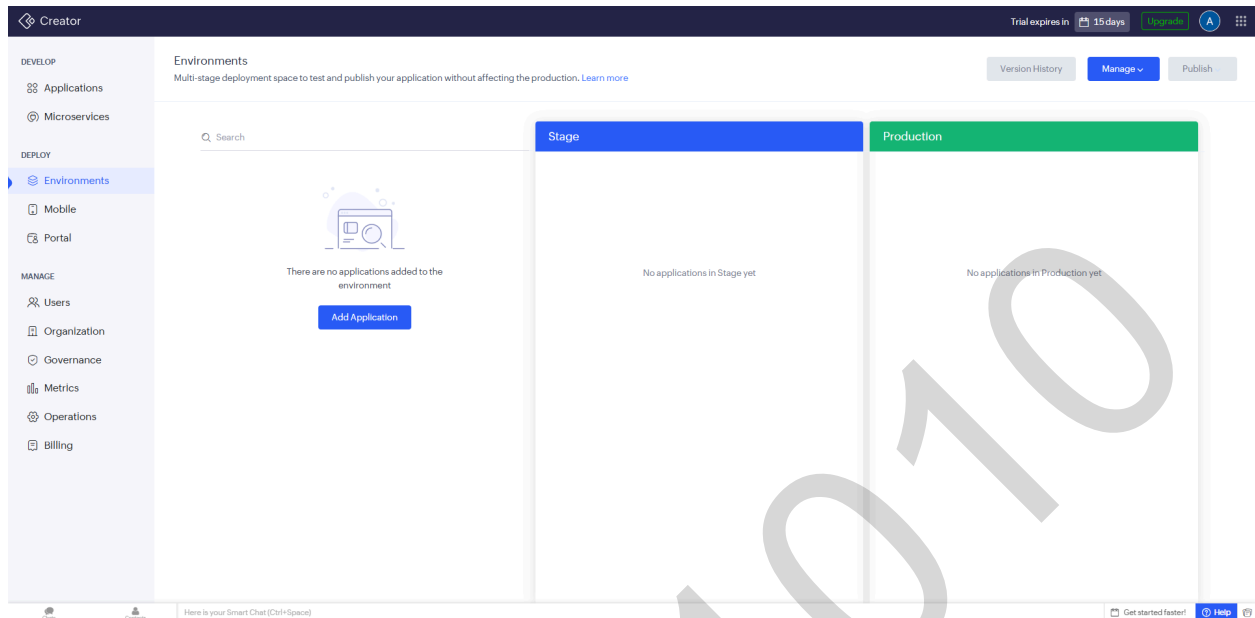
- Allows developers to create their own APIs.
- Defines custom actions and endpoints for applications.
- Enables communication between Zoho Creator and other software.

Examples:

- Employee Management API
- Order Tracking API
- Inventory API
- Payment API

Advantages:

- Flexible integration
- Secure data sharing
- Supports custom business requirements



Environments in Zoho Creator

The **Environments** page in Zoho Creator is used to develop, test, and deploy applications safely without affecting the live application.

1. Development

- Build and modify the application.
- Add new features and fix bugs.

2. Stage

- Test the application before release.
- Ensure everything works correctly.

3. Production

- Live version used by end users.
- Only approved changes are published here.

Other Features

- **Add Application:** Add a new application to the environment.

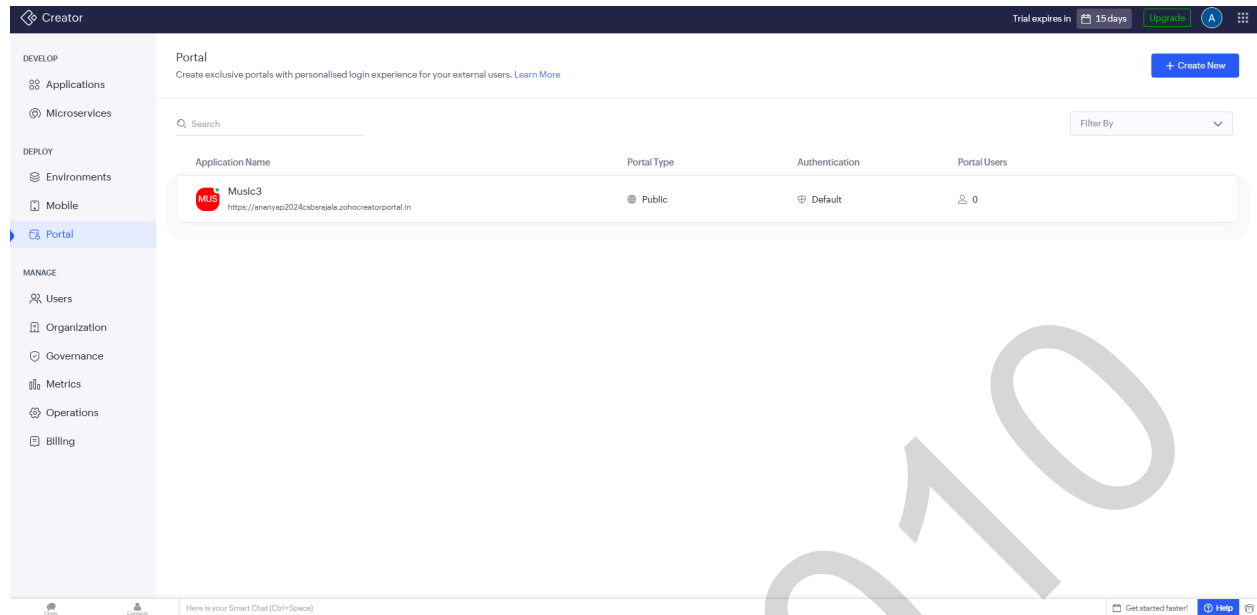
- **Search:** Find applications quickly.
- **Version History:** View previous versions.
- **Manage:** Configure deployment settings.
- **Publish:** Move the tested application to Production.

Deployment Flow

Development → **Stage** → **Production**

Advantages

- Safe development
- Easy testing
- Reliable deployment
- Better application quality



Portal in Zoho Creator

The **Portal** feature in Zoho Creator enables organizations to create **secure web portals** for external users such as customers, vendors, partners, students, or employees. It provides a personalized login experience, allowing users to access only the application data and features assigned to them without giving full access to the Zoho Creator workspace.

Features

1. Create New

- Create a new portal for an existing application.
- Configure portal settings based on business requirements.

2. Application Name

- Displays the application associated with the portal.
- Each application can have its own dedicated portal.

3. Portal Type

- Defines the accessibility of the portal.
- **Public:** Accessible to anyone with the portal link.
- **Private:** Accessible only to authenticated users.

4. Authentication

- Manages the login method for portal users.
- Supports secure authentication using usernames, passwords, or integrated authentication services.

5. Portal Users

- Displays the number of registered users.
- Allows administrators to add, remove, and manage portal users.

6. Search and Filter

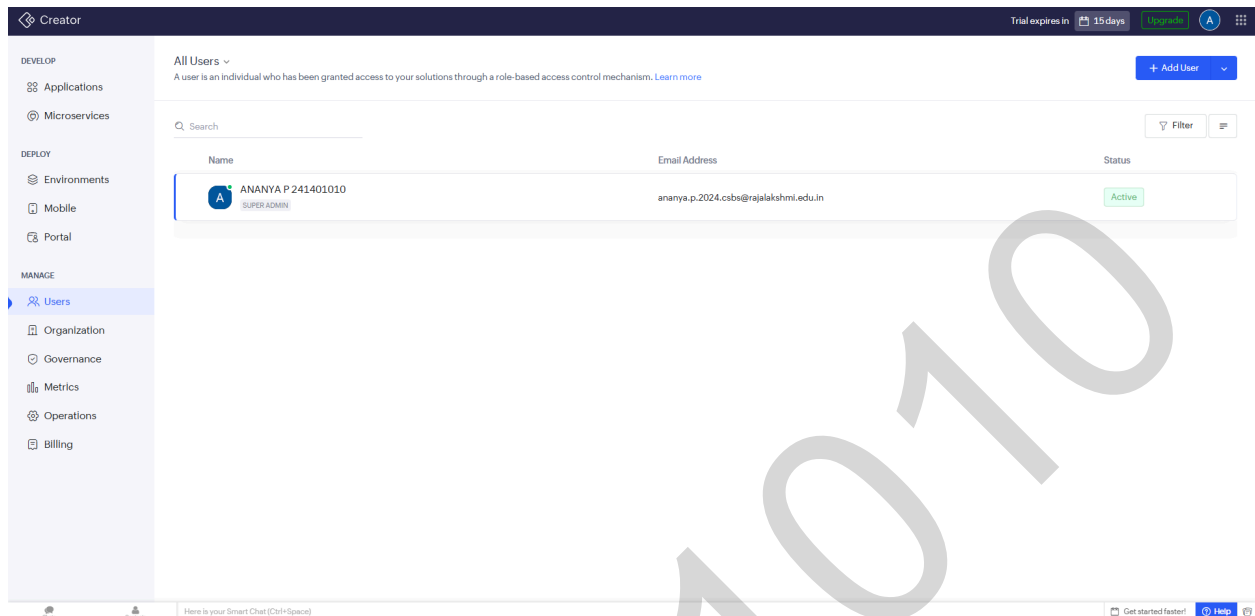
- Quickly locate portals using the search bar.
- Filter portals based on different criteria for easier management.

Advantages

- Provides secure access for external users.
- Offers personalized login and user experience.
- Protects application data through role-based access control.
- Simplifies collaboration with customers, vendors, and partners.
- Eliminates the need to provide full Creator access.

Applications

- Customer Support Portal
- Employee Self-Service Portal
- Vendor Management Portal
- Student Information Portal
- Patient Management Portal
- Supplier and Partner Portal



Users in Zoho Creator

The **Users** module in Zoho Creator is used to **manage all users** who have access to the organization's applications. It enables administrators to add users, assign roles, control permissions, and monitor user status through **role-based access control (RBAC)**, ensuring secure and organized access to applications.

Features

1. Add User

- Add new users to the organization.
- Invite users using their email address.
- Assign appropriate roles during user creation.

2. User Details

- Displays user information such as:
 - Name
 - Email Address
 - Assigned Role (e.g., Super Admin, Admin, Developer, User)
 - Account Status

3. User Roles

- Assign different roles based on responsibilities.
- Roles determine the level of access to applications and data.
- Example roles include Super Admin, Admin, Developer, and End User.

4. Status

- Shows whether a user's account is **Active** or **Inactive**.
- Inactive users cannot access the applications until reactivated.

5. Search and Filter

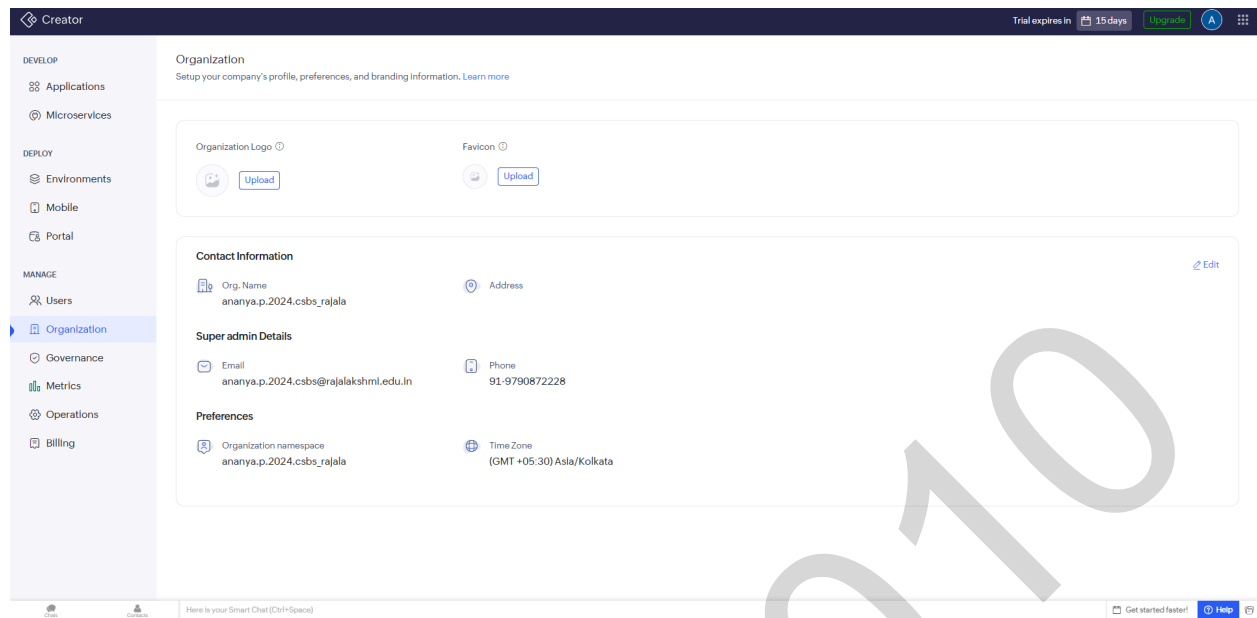
- Search users by name or email.
- Filter users based on role, status, or other criteria for easier management.

Advantages

- Centralized user management.
- Secure role-based access control.
- Easy addition and removal of users.
- Protects sensitive business data by limiting user permissions.
- Simplifies administration of multiple users.

Applications

- Employee Management
- Team Collaboration
- Department-wise Access Control
- Enterprise Application Management
- Secure User Administration



Organization in Zoho Creator

The **Organization** module in Zoho Creator is used to configure and manage the organization's profile, branding, contact information, and preferences. It serves as the central place for setting up organization-wide details that are used across all applications.

Features

1. Organization Logo

- Upload and manage the organization's logo.
- Displays the company logo across applications and portals.

2. Favicon

- Upload a favicon (website icon) displayed in the browser tab.
- Improves branding and identification of the application.

3. Contact Information

- Store organization details such as:
 - Organization Name
 - Address
 - Email Address
 - Phone Number
- These details are used for communication and identification.

4. Super Admin Details

- Displays information about the Super Admin.
- Includes the administrator's email and contact number.
- The Super Admin has full control over the organization and its applications.

5. Preferences

- Configure organization settings such as:
 - Organization Namespace
 - Time Zone
- Ensures applications follow the correct regional settings.

6. Edit Option

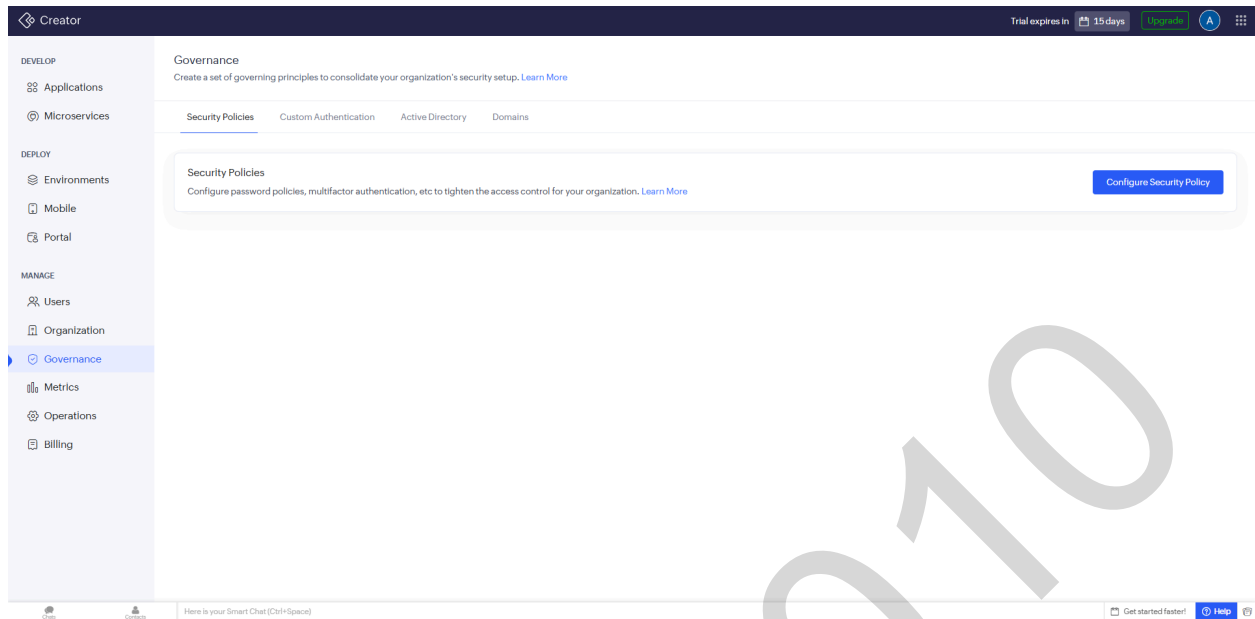
- Allows administrators to update organization details, branding, and preferences whenever required.

Advantages

- Centralized organization management.
- Maintains consistent branding across applications.
- Stores important organization and administrator details.
- Supports easy customization of organizational settings.
- Ensures proper configuration for all users and applications.

Applications

- Company Profile Management
- Organization Branding
- Administrator Management
- Regional and Time Zone Configuration
- Enterprise Application Setup



Governance in Zoho Creator

The **Governance** module in Zoho Creator is used to **manage the security and access control** of an organization. It helps administrators define security policies, configure authentication methods, integrate with enterprise directories, and control domain access to ensure secure application usage.

Features

1. Security Policies

- Configure password rules and account security.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Improve protection against unauthorized access.

2. Custom Authentication

- Set up custom login methods.
- Integrate with external authentication providers for secure user login.

3. Active Directory

- Integrate Zoho Creator with an organization's Active Directory.
- Automatically manage users and authentication from a centralized directory.

4. Domains

- Restrict access to users from approved email domains.
- Helps ensure only authorized users can access the applications.

5. Configure Security Policy

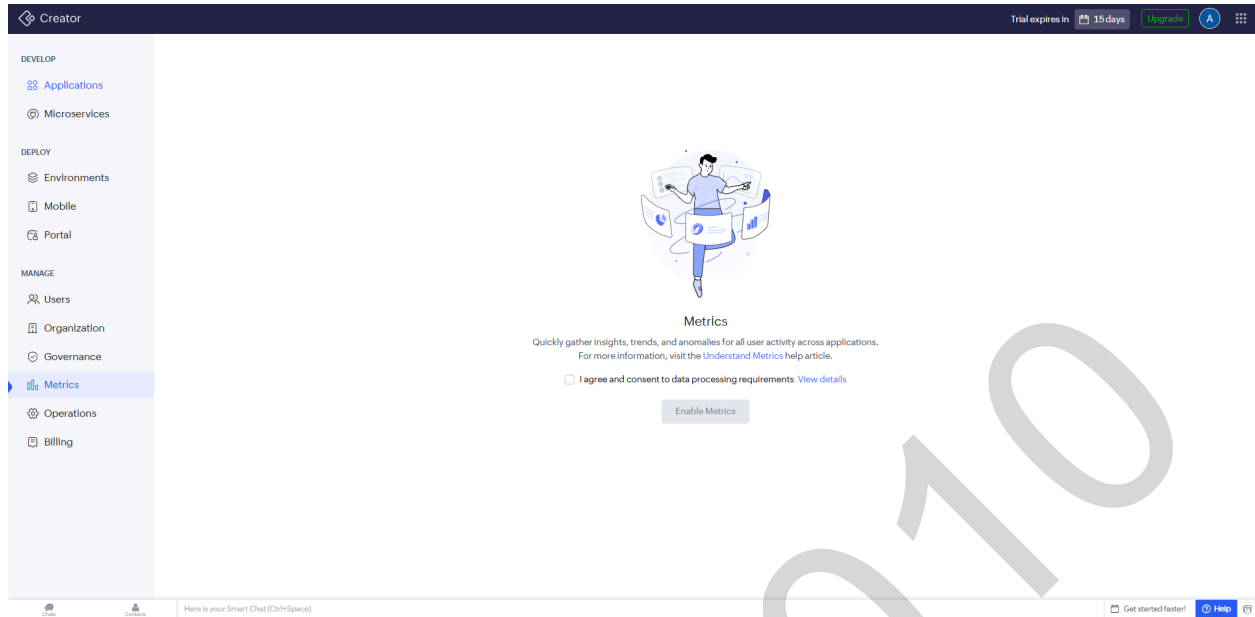
- Create and manage organization-wide security settings.
- Apply consistent security rules across all users and applications.

Advantages

- Enhances application security.
- Provides centralized access control.
- Supports secure user authentication.
- Protects sensitive organizational data.
- Ensures compliance with security standards.

Applications

- Enterprise Security Management
- User Authentication
- Access Control
- Identity Management
- Organization-wide Security Policy Enforcement



Metrics in Zoho Creator

The **Metrics** module in Zoho Creator helps administrators **monitor and analyze application performance and user activity**. It provides insights into application usage, trends, and system performance, enabling organizations to make informed decisions and improve application efficiency.

Features

1. User Activity Monitoring

- Tracks user interactions with applications.
- Displays usage patterns and activity history.

2. Performance Insights

- Monitors application performance and response trends.
- Helps identify performance bottlenecks.

3. Trends and Analytics

- Provides reports on application usage over time.
- Analyzes trends to support better decision-making.

4. Anomaly Detection

- Detects unusual activities or unexpected behavior.

- Helps administrators identify potential issues quickly.

5. Enable Metrics

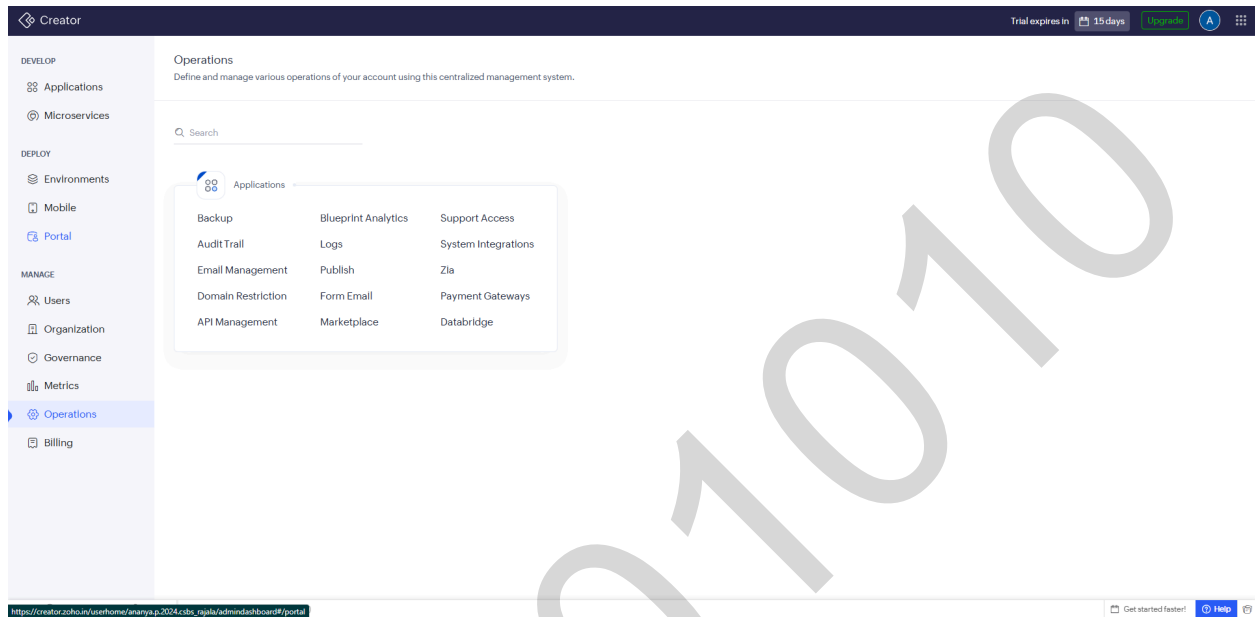
- Allows administrators to activate metrics collection.
- Requires user consent for data processing before enabling.

Advantages

- Monitors application performance.
- Provides valuable business insights.
- Detects anomalies and performance issues.
- Helps improve user experience.
- Supports data-driven decision making.

Applications

- Application Performance Monitoring
- User Activity Analysis
- Business Analytics
- Usage Reporting
- Performance Optimization



Operations in Zoho Creator

The **Operations** module in Zoho Creator provides a centralized place to manage application maintenance, integrations, security, and deployment. It helps administrators monitor applications, manage backups, publish updates, and configure various operational settings.

Features

1. Backup

- Create and restore application backups.
- Protects data from accidental loss.

2. Audit Trail

- Tracks user activities and system changes.
- Maintains a record for security and compliance.

3. Email Management

- Configure email settings for notifications and alerts.
- Manage outgoing emails from applications.

4. Logs

- View application logs and error reports.
- Helps identify and troubleshoot issues.

5. Publish

- Deploy updated applications to end users.
- Makes new features available after testing.

6. API Management

- Manage APIs used for application integration.
- Enables secure communication with external systems.

7. System Integrations

- Connect applications with third-party services.
- Supports seamless data exchange.

8. Payment Gateways

- Integrate online payment services.
- Supports secure online transactions.

9. Marketplace

- Access and install extensions or add-ons.
- Enhances application functionality.

10. Zia

- Integrate Zoho's AI assistant for automation and intelligent features.

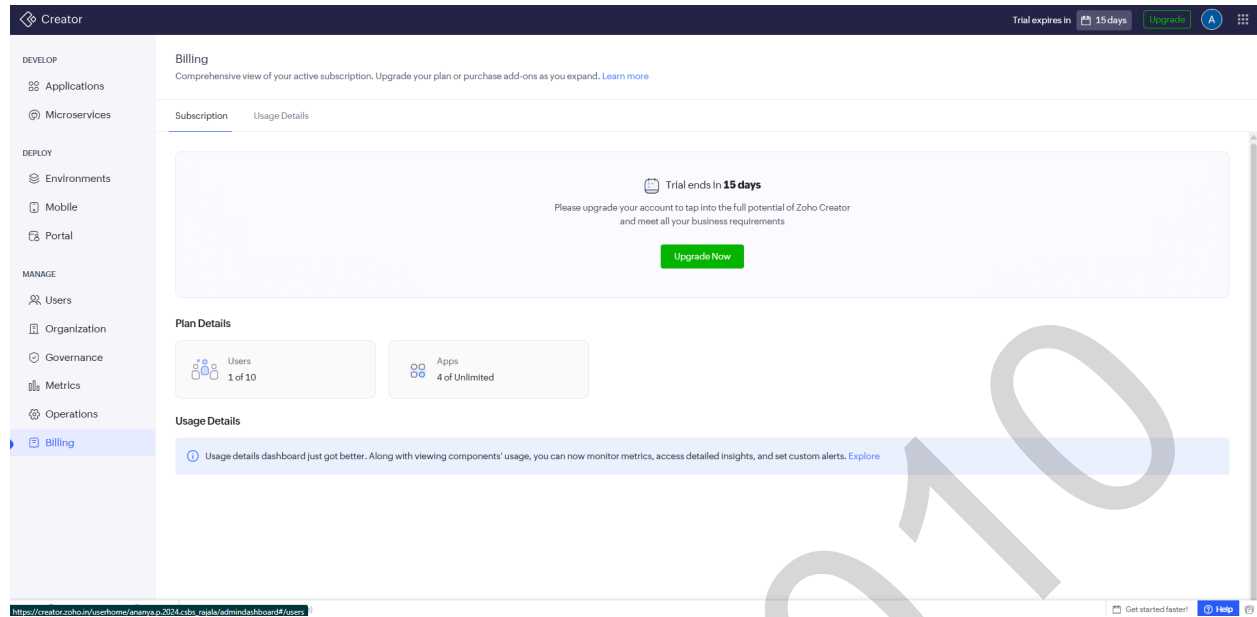
Advantages

- Centralized application management.
- Secure backup and recovery.
- Easy monitoring and troubleshooting.
- Supports integrations and online payments.
- Simplifies deployment and maintenance.

Applications

- Backup and Recovery
- Application Monitoring
- API & Third-party Integration
- Payment Processing
- System Administration

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Billing in Zoho Creator

The **Billing** module in Zoho Creator is used to manage the organization's **subscription plan, licensing, and usage details**. It allows administrators to view plan information, monitor resource usage, and upgrade or renew the subscription when required.

Features

1. Subscription

- Displays the current subscription plan.
- Shows the trial period or plan validity.
- Provides an option to upgrade the plan.

2. Plan Details

- Displays the number of:
 - Users
 - Applications
- Shows the usage limits of the current plan.

3. Usage Details

- Monitors resource usage such as users, applications, and other services.
- Helps track overall platform usage.

4. Upgrade Plan

- Allows organizations to upgrade to a higher plan.
- Unlocks additional features and resources.

5. Trial Information

- Shows the remaining trial period.
- Reminds users to upgrade before the trial expires.

Advantages

- Easy subscription management.
- Tracks resource usage.
- Helps avoid exceeding plan limits.
- Supports plan upgrades as business needs grow.
- Provides a centralized view of billing information.

Applications

- Subscription Management
- License Management
- Resource Usage Monitoring
- Plan Upgrades
- Billing Administration